

Claude API Integration

Smart Onboarding with URL Analysis and Conditional Follow-up Questions

Prepared for: Muhammad Ismaeel | Stormo.io | June 2026 | Hardball Ventures LLC

This document specifies how to integrate the Claude API into Stormo's onboarding flow in two ways. First, when a merchant provides their store URL in Topic 1, the system fetches and analyzes it with Claude to understand the store's positioning and products. Second, Claude uses context from all merchant answers to parse free text responses and extract key data points. Only follow-up questions for missing information are displayed, making the onboarding feel conversational and intelligent. This is a launch blocker feature.

LAUNCH BLOCKER: This feature must be implemented before the first merchant-facing release. URL analysis immediately provides Claude with store context. Conditional follow-ups make the onboarding intelligent. Together they define the first impression of Stormo's AI quality.

1. Architecture Overview

1.1 Two-Part Claude Integration

The onboarding uses Claude API in two distinct ways:

Part 1: Store URL Analysis (Topic 1)

When the merchant enters their store URL, the system immediately fetches the homepage and passes it to Claude for analysis. Claude examines the store and returns context: what they sell, their positioning, product categories, price tier, unique selling points. This context informs every follow-up question in the rest of the onboarding.

Part 2: Answer Parsing (All Topics)

After the merchant answers any free text question, Claude parses that answer to extract key data points. Only follow-up questions for missing information are displayed. A merchant who provides complete answers skips follow-ups. A merchant who provides thin answers gets gentle guidance.

1.2 Why This Matters

- URL analysis makes Claude immediately knowledgeable about the actual store, not just the merchant's description.
- Follow-up questions can be tailored based on what Claude found at the URL, not generic.
- Merchants who describe their store completely skip redundant follow-ups.
- First impression of Stormo's AI intelligence is formed in Topic 1 and reinforced throughout.

1.3 Cost and Performance

URL Fetch Cost: Minimal. A single HTTP GET to the homepage is one request, <5KB of data typically.

Claude API Calls: Approximately 6-7 calls per onboarding. URL analysis plus answer parsing for 5 topics. At \$3 per million input tokens, cost per merchant is negligible.

Latency: URL fetch adds 200-500ms. Claude calls add 200-500ms each. Total added latency to onboarding approximately 2-3 seconds. Acceptable.

2. URL Analysis Feature

2.1 How URL Analysis Works

Step 1: Merchant enters their store URL in Topic 1

Step 2: Frontend validates the URL format and reachability

Step 3: Backend fetches the homepage HTML

Step 4: Backend sends the HTML to Claude with analysis prompt

Step 5: Claude returns structured analysis: product categories, positioning, price tier, niche, unique elements

Step 6: Frontend displays the analysis and uses it to customize follow-up questions

2.2 What Claude Extracts from URL Analysis

- Primary product categories and what they sell
- Positioning: luxury, budget, mid-market, boutique, mass market
- Price tier: sub-\$25, \$25-75, \$75-150, \$150+
- Store stage: new and empty, early products, established catalog
- Unique value propositions: handmade, organic, vintage, sustainable, etc.
- Visual aesthetic: minimalist, maximalist, trendy, classic, artisanal
- Target audience signals: age demographic, gender, lifestyle

2.3 Using URL Analysis in Follow-ups

After Claude analyzes the store, the onboarding becomes smarter. Examples:

If Claude detects handmade leather goods: Ask about production capacity, turnaround times, material sourcing instead of generic product questions.

If Claude detects luxury positioning: Ask about target income level, brand storytelling approach instead of treating it like a general store.

If Claude detects a new store with few products: Ask about expansion plans and product roadmap.

2.4 Backend Implementation

Create a new endpoint POST `/api/onboarding/analyze-store-url` that:

- Accepts the store URL
- Validates the URL format
- Fetches the homepage using Node.js fetch or axios
- Extracts text content from the HTML using cheerio or similar
- Sends the extracted content to Claude with a structured analysis prompt
- Returns the analysis as JSON
- Gracefully handles unreachable URLs, invalid formats, timeouts

2.5 Error Handling for URL Analysis

If the URL is unreachable or invalid:

- Display a user-friendly error message: The store URL could not be reached. Please check the URL and try again.
- Allow the merchant to try again or skip URL analysis
- If skipped, proceed with onboarding but show all follow-up questions as a fallback
- Log the error for debugging but never crash the onboarding

3. Answer Parsing Feature

After URL analysis, every free text answer in the remaining topics is parsed by Claude to extract data and identify missing information.

3.1 Answer Parsing Flow

Step 1: Merchant submits free text answer to any question

Step 2: Frontend sends answer to POST /api/onboarding/parse-answer

Step 3: Backend sends answer to Claude with topic-specific prompt

Step 4: Claude extracts all data points and identifies missing fields

Step 5: Frontend conditionally renders only follow-up questions for missing fields

3.2 Topic-Specific Parsing

Each topic requires a different Claude prompt:

- **Topic 1:** Extract storeURL, productCategory, foundingStory, geographicReach, fulfillmentModel
- **Topic 2:** Extract gender, ageRange, incomeLevel, interests, location, purchaseMotivation
- **Topic 3:** Extract storeAge, salesCount, marketingAttempted, resultsOfAttempts
- **Topic 4:** Extract weeklyHours, onCamera, socialMediaComfort, contentFormats
- **Topic 5:** Extract nineDayTarget, sideProjectOrMainIncome, successDefinition

4. Environment and Error Handling

4.1 Vercel Environment Variables

Store the Anthropic API key in Vercel: `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-xxxxx`. Verify at startup. If missing, throw an error immediately.

4.2 Error Handling Strategy

If any Claude API call fails, gracefully degrade. For URL analysis, show all follow-ups. For answer parsing, assume all fields are missing. Never crash the onboarding.

4.3 Timeout Handling

URL fetches should timeout after 5 seconds. Claude API calls should timeout after 15 seconds. On timeout, return a user-friendly error and allow retry or skip.

4.4 Confidence Threshold

Claude returns a confidence score for parsing. If below 70 percent, show all follow-up questions as a fallback rather than risk extracting wrong data.

5. Testing Requirements

Before launch, test both URL analysis and answer parsing with real examples.

5.1 URL Analysis Test Cases

Test	URL Type	Expected
Valid Shopify store	Example Shopify site	Correctly identify products, positioning, price tier
WooCommerce store	Example WooCommerce site	Correctly identify platform and store details
New empty store	Mostly blank homepage	Detect early stage, minimal products
Invalid URL	Nonexistent domain	Gracefully handle with user-friendly error
Unreachable URL	Valid domain, server down	Timeout gracefully and allow retry

5.2 Answer Parsing Test Cases

Scenario	Answer	Expected Follow-ups
Complete detail	women 25-45 urban mid-upper fashion quality	None
Generic answer	women who like fashion	Ask: age, income, location
Partial answer	women 25-45 fashion	Ask: income, location, interests
Vague answer	my customers	Show all follow-ups

5.3 Real Store Testing

Before launch, test URL analysis against at least 10 real merchant stores across different niches: fashion, handmade, POD, dropship, digital. Verify Claude correctly identifies positioning, products, and price tier.

6. Timeline

This feature should take approximately 10-12 days to fully implement and test.

- Day 1-2: Set up URL fetching and HTML parsing library
- Day 3-4: Build store URL analysis endpoint and Claude prompt
- Day 5-6: Build answer parsing endpoint and topic-specific prompts
- Day 7-8: Frontend implementation for URL analysis and conditional rendering
- Day 9-10: Error handling, timeouts, graceful degradation
- Day 11-12: Testing with real stores and test cases, refinement

DELIVERABLE: Fully functional onboarding with URL analysis and intelligent answer parsing, comprehensive error handling, passing all test cases with 10 real stores before launch.

Engagement and Moving Forward

Product Specification for Post-Onboarding Experience

Prepared for: Muhammad Ismaeel | Stormo.io | June 2026 | Hardball Ventures LLC

This document specifies how Stormo engages merchants after onboarding is complete. It covers daily action plan delivery from Day 2 onward, all merchant communication strategies, sales tracking, Growth plan unlock mechanics, early unlock via support, and plan switching. All features described here must be built as part of the Stormo product. This document supersedes any prior verbal or informal discussions on these topics.

IMPORTANT: Onboarding is the entry point. Everything in this document is what makes Stormo a product merchants return to every day. These features are not optional enhancements they are core to the product's value proposition and must be fully implemented.

1. Daily Action Plan Delivery

1.1 Day 1 Experience

When a merchant completes onboarding Stormo immediately generates their personalized acquisition plan and presents their first daily action. The action is displayed on the dashboard with a full description of what to do and why, a generated copy template ready to use, and a platform tag indicating which channel the action is for. The merchant reads the action, understands what is expected, and goes and does it on their own time. There is no prompt for results at this stage. Results are logged later from the dashboard when the merchant is ready.

KEY PRINCIPLE: Stormo delivers the action and gets out of the way. The merchant may complete the action an hour later, that evening, or the next day. Stormo does not pressure or remind within the first 24 hours.

1.2 Day 2 and Beyond

Each morning at 8 AM in the merchant's local time zone, Stormo generates and delivers a new daily action. Actions are not random. They are sequenced intelligently based on the following inputs:

- The merchant's onboarding profile including niche, customer, capacity, and goals
- What actions have already been completed and their logged results
- What platform or channel was targeted most recently to ensure variety
- The merchant's stated weekly capacity so actions never exceed what they can handle
- Seasonal relevance and upcoming opportunities relevant to their niche
- Whether the merchant is on Starter or Growth tier which affects action complexity

1.3 Action Rotation and Variety

Stormo must rotate actions across different channels and tactics to prevent repetition and keep merchants engaged. The AI should not assign the same type of action two days in a row. A balanced weekly rotation should include:

Day	Channel Focus	Example Action Type
Monday	Social media content	Instagram post or Pinterest pin
Tuesday	Community and outreach	Engage in niche Facebook group or Reddit
Wednesday	Email and list building	Add signup form or send first email
Thursday	Content and SEO	Write product description or blog post

Friday	Influencer outreach	Find and contact a micro influencer
Saturday	Review and optimize	Update product photos or store copy
Sunday	Planning	Review the week and prepare next action

1.4 Action Status and Results Logging

The dashboard must display each action with a clear status indicator and the ability to log results at any time after completion. The action card on the dashboard should show:

- The action title and platform tag
- The date it was assigned
- Status options: Pending, Completed, Skipped
- A results section that is empty until the merchant fills it in
- A simple results input with options for reach, engagement, followers gained, sales attributed, and a free text field for additional notes
- A timestamp showing when results were last updated

Results logging must be available at any time from the dashboard. There is no deadline or prompt forcing the merchant to log results immediately. The AI uses logged results over time to refine future action recommendations.

2. Merchant Communication Strategy

2.1 Email Communication Sequence

All emails are sent from info@stormo.io via Zoho Mail. The following sequence is triggered automatically based on merchant activity and timeline.

Trigger	Email	Timing
Onboarding complete	Welcome. Your plan is ready. Here is your first action.	Immediately
Day 1 action assigned	Summary of first action with link to dashboard	Same day
No login after 3 days	Your daily actions are waiting. Here is what is next.	Day 3
First action completed	Great start. Here is what to expect this week.	Same day
7 days inactive	We noticed you have not been back. Here is a quick win action.	Day 7
First sale logged	Your first sale. Here is how to build on this momentum.	Same day
5 sales logged	Halfway to Growth. Here is what unlocks at 10 sales.	Same day
10 sales reached	You have unlocked the Growth plan. Here is what is new.	Same day
14 days inactive	Final re-engagement. Are you still building your store?	Day 14
30 days as member	Monthly milestone. Here is your progress summary.	Day 30
Trial ending in 3 days	Your \$9 trial ends soon. Continue for \$29 per month.	Day 27

2.2 Push Notification Strategy

Push notifications are available to merchants who have installed Stormo as a PWA on their home screen and granted notification permission. Push notifications are used for high-value time-sensitive alerts only. They should never be used for generic marketing messages.

Approved push notification triggers:

- New daily action is ready each morning
- A new AI insight or audience segment has been identified
- The merchant is approaching a sales milestone
- A seasonal opportunity is coming up in their niche within the next 7 days
- The merchant has not logged in for 3 days

LIMIT: No more than two push notifications per day. Merchants who feel spammed will disable notifications entirely. Quality over frequency.

2.3 In-App Messaging

In addition to email and push, Stormo displays contextual messages within the dashboard itself. These appear as banners or cards and are used for:

- Celebrating milestones such as first completed action, first sale, and 10 sales
- Surfacing new AI insights that have been generated since the last login
- Prompting the merchant to log results for actions completed more than 48 hours ago
- Reminding the merchant how many days remain in their \$9 trial period
- Announcing Growth plan features when the merchant reaches 8 or more sales

3. Ongoing Engagement Strategies

3.1 Progress Tracking and Milestones

The dashboard must include a visible progress tracker that shows the merchant where they are in their journey. This is a key engagement tool that gives merchants a sense of momentum and forward motion. The progress tracker should show:

- Total actions completed to date
- Current streak of consecutive days with an action completed
- Total sales logged to date with a visual progress bar toward 10 sales
- Days as a Stormo member
- Most used channel based on completed actions

3.2 Weekly Summary

Every Monday morning Stormo sends a weekly summary email and displays a summary card on the dashboard. The weekly summary includes:

- Number of actions completed last week
- Any results logged and highlights from the week
- A preview of what is coming this week
- An encouraging message personalized to the merchant's progress stage
- A reminder of how many sales have been logged toward the Growth unlock

3.3 AI Insight Alerts

Beyond the daily action, Stormo's AI should periodically surface new insights based on the merchant's profile and activity. These appear as insight cards on the dashboard and trigger a push notification or email when generated. Examples include:

- A new audience segment the merchant has not targeted yet
- A trending topic or hashtag in their niche right now
- A seasonal event coming up that is relevant to their products
- A competitor gap or positioning opportunity identified by the AI
- A content format that is performing well in their category on a specific platform

AI insights should be generated at least once per week per merchant. They supplement the daily action rather than replacing it.

3.4 Inactive Merchant Re-engagement

If a merchant has not logged in for 7 or more days the following re-engagement sequence activates:

- **Day 7** Day 7 email and push: Your actions are waiting. Here is a quick win to get back on track.
- **Day 14** Day 14 email: Final check-in. Are you still building your store? Here is what you missed.
- **Day 21** Day 21: No further automated contact. Merchant remains in the system and can return at any time.

NOTE: Inactive merchants are never deleted or downgraded automatically. Their plan and data remain intact. They can return at any time and pick up where they left off.

4. Sales Tracking

4.1 How Sales Are Logged

Stormo does not integrate directly with the merchant's store platform in Version 1. Sales are self-reported by the merchant. The dashboard must include a simple and prominent sales logging mechanism that makes it easy for merchants to record each sale as it happens.

The sales logging interface must include:

- A clearly visible sales counter on the main dashboard showing current total sales
- A simple button or input to log a new sale
- An optional field to attribute the sale to a specific action or channel
- A running log of all sales with dates for the merchant to review
- A visual progress bar showing progress toward 10 sales with the Growth unlock shown at the end

4.2 Sales Counter Display

The sales counter must be one of the most prominent elements on the dashboard. It should be impossible for a merchant to miss it. The display should show the current count, for example 4 of 10 sales, with a progress bar and a label that reads something like Unlock Growth at 10 sales. This creates a visible goal that motivates merchants to keep taking action.

4.3 Sale Attribution

When a merchant logs a sale they should have the option to attribute it to a specific Stormo action or channel. This is optional but encouraged. Over time this data allows the AI to identify which types of actions are producing results for this specific merchant and weight future recommendations accordingly.

5. Growth Plan Unlock

5.1 Standard Unlock at 10 Sales

When a merchant logs their 10th sale Stormo triggers the Growth plan unlock automatically. The following sequence occurs immediately:

- A congratulations message appears on the dashboard celebrating the milestone
- A Growth plan unlock card appears showing what new features are now available
- An email is sent: You have reached 10 sales. The Growth plan is now unlocked for you.
- A push notification is sent if the merchant has notifications enabled
- The upgrade option becomes prominently visible on the dashboard and in account settings

CRITICAL: The Growth plan is never activated automatically. Reaching 10 sales unlocks the option to upgrade. The merchant must choose to upgrade and complete the Stripe billing change themselves. No automatic charges or plan changes under any circumstances.

5.2 What Growth Unlocks

When a merchant upgrades to Growth at \$39 per month they receive the following additional features on top of everything included in Starter:

- Paid advertising guidance and action plans including Meta Ads and Google Ads basics
- More advanced influencer outreach strategies and templates
- Deeper AI insights with competitive analysis and market positioning
- Priority support response time
- Access to seasonal campaign planning tools further in advance
- Advanced results analytics comparing their performance over time

5.3 Early Growth Unlock via Support

Experienced store owners who already have sales history before joining Stormo should not be required to reach 10 sales within Stormo to access Growth features. An early unlock path must be available through support.

How the early unlock process works:

- The merchant contacts Stormo support via the in-app support option or by emailing info@stormo.io
- They explain that they are an experienced seller and request early Growth access
- Support reviews the request and can manually unlock Growth for the merchant's account

- The merchant is notified by email that Growth has been unlocked and can upgrade at any time
- The merchant still completes the Stripe billing upgrade themselves

This must be acknowledged in the product in the following places:

- On the dashboard in the Growth unlock section there must be a line that reads: Already an experienced seller? Contact support to unlock Growth early.
- In the FAQ section of the website
- In the onboarding flow when a merchant indicates they already have sales

WHY THIS MATTERS: Without an early unlock path Stormo turns away its most valuable potential customers. An experienced seller who joins Stormo and sees they must log 10 new sales before accessing advanced features will leave for a more capable tool. The early unlock via support keeps them in the product.

6. Plan Switching

6.1 Upgrading from Starter to Growth

When a merchant chooses to upgrade from Starter to Growth the following must occur:

- The upgrade is initiated by the merchant from their account settings or the Growth unlock card on the dashboard
- Stripe handles the billing change. The merchant is charged the prorated difference for the current billing period
- Growth features are activated immediately upon successful payment
- A confirmation email is sent: Welcome to Growth. Here is what is now available to you.
- The dashboard updates to reflect Growth status with a visual indicator
- The daily action plan immediately begins incorporating Growth-tier actions including paid advertising guidance

6.2 Downgrading from Growth to Starter

A merchant may choose to downgrade from Growth back to Starter. The following must occur:

- The downgrade is initiated by the merchant from account settings only. There is no automatic downgrade.
- The merchant retains Growth access until the end of their current billing period
- At the next billing date they are charged \$29 per month for Starter
- Growth-exclusive features become unavailable at the start of the new billing period
- All data, action history, and sales records are retained
- A confirmation email is sent when the downgrade takes effect
- The merchant can upgrade again at any time if they choose

6.3 Trial to Paid Conversion

The \$9 trial lasts 30 days. At the end of the trial the merchant is automatically billed \$29 per month for Starter unless they have cancelled. The following communication sequence supports trial conversion:

- **Day 1:** Trial welcome email explaining what to expect in the first 30 days
- **Day 15:** Mid-trial check-in highlighting progress made so far
- **Day 27:** Trial ending reminder with a summary of value delivered
- **Day 29:** Final reminder: trial ends tomorrow
- **Day 30:** Billing confirmation email when Starter subscription begins

6.4 Cancellation

A merchant may cancel at any time from account settings. Cancellation must be straightforward with no dark patterns or excessive friction. When a merchant cancels:

- They retain access until the end of their current billing period
- No further charges are made
- Their data is retained for 60 days per the Privacy Policy before deletion
- A cancellation confirmation email is sent immediately
- A single re-engagement email is sent 7 days after cancellation asking if there is anything Stormo can improve
- No further contact after that unless the merchant returns

IMPORTANT: All billing mechanics described in this section are handled through Stripe. The Stormo backend must correctly handle Stripe webhooks for subscription upgrades, downgrades, cancellations, and failed payments. Failed payment handling must include a grace period email sequence before access is suspended.

7. Implementation Summary

The following table summarizes all features in this document with their priority level for implementation.

Feature	Section	Priority
Daily action delivery from Day 2 onward	1.2	Launch Blocker
Action rotation across channels	1.3	Launch Blocker
Results logging on dashboard	1.4	Launch Blocker
Email communication sequence	2.1	Launch Blocker
Push notification triggers	2.2	Pre-Launch
In-app messaging and banners	2.3	Pre-Launch
Progress tracker on dashboard	3.1	Launch Blocker
Weekly summary email	3.2	Pre-Launch
AI insight alerts	3.3	Pre-Launch
Inactive merchant re-engagement	3.4	Pre-Launch
Sales logging interface	4.1	Launch Blocker
Sales counter and progress bar	4.2	Launch Blocker
Sale attribution to actions	4.3	Version 2
Growth unlock at 10 sales	5.1	Launch Blocker
Early Growth unlock via support	5.3	Launch Blocker
Upgrade Starter to Growth	6.1	Launch Blocker
Downgrade Growth to Starter	6.2	Launch Blocker
Trial to paid conversion sequence	6.3	Launch Blocker
Cancellation flow	6.4	Launch Blocker

Please review this document in full and confirm receipt. Advise on your implementation plan and timeline for each Launch Blocker item before proceeding to the next phase. Questions and clarifications are welcome.

Phase 3: AI Learning System

How Stormo Learns from Results and Improves Recommendations

Prepared for: Muhammad Ismaeel | Stormo.io | June 2026 | Hardball Ventures LLC

This document specifies Phase 3: how Stormo collects merchant performance data, analyzes it, and feeds it back to Claude to generate increasingly intelligent daily action recommendations. Phase 3 is NOT required for launch. It comes after Phase 2 is stable and you have merchants actively logging results.

PHASE 3 TIMING: Implement after Phase 2 is complete and you have 50+ active merchants with results logged. This is a performance and intelligence enhancement, not a launch blocker.

1. Overview

In Phase 1 and 2, Stormo generates actions based on onboarding profile. But it does not know what actually works for each merchant. Phase 3 adds a feedback loop. When merchants log results, that data is stored and analyzed. Claude uses this history to generate smarter recommendations tailored to what has worked for that specific merchant.

Example: A merchant completes 20 actions. Instagram posts average 12% engagement. TikTok videos average 5% engagement. Email gets 3% click-through but 5% conversion to sales. Phase 3 tells Claude: Prioritize Instagram and email based on this merchant's actual data.

2. Data Collection

2.1 Source of Data

All data comes from merchant input. Merchants provide results when they log:

- Reach: How many people saw the action
- Engagement: Likes, comments, clicks, interactions
- Attributed Sales: Sales directly from this action
- Clicks to Store: Traffic driven by this action
- Email List Additions: New subscribers from this action

2.2 Database Tables

ActionResult: Raw results logged for each action

- action_id: links to the generated action
- merchant_id: which merchant
- platform: instagram, tiktok, email, etc.
- action_type: video, carousel, email, blog, etc.
- date_completed: when completed
- reach: viewers
- engagement: interactions
- attributed_sales: revenue from this action

StrategyPerformance: Aggregated metrics per merchant per platform

- merchant_id
- platform

- action_type
- avg_engagement_rate: engagement / reach
- avg_conversion_rate: attributed_sales / reach
- total_attributed_sales: total revenue from this platform
- action_count: how many actions of this type
- last_updated: when metrics were last calculated

3. Analytics

3.1 Daily Aggregation Job

Nightly, a backend job aggregates ActionResult data into StrategyPerformance:

- Query all ActionResults logged in past 90 days
- Group by merchant_id, platform, action_type
- Calculate avg_engagement_rate and avg_conversion_rate
- Count total actions and attributed sales
- Update StrategyPerformance table

3.2 When to Use Performance Data

Only include in Claude prompts if:

- Merchant has 20+ actions logged (enough data for signal)
- Action type has been tried 3+ times (pattern exists)
- Data is from past 60 days (recent and relevant)

3.3 Handling Sparse Data

Early on, merchants have few results. Don't overfit to limited data. After action_count reaches 50+, heavily weight performance data in recommendations.

4. Feeding to Claude

4.1 Dynamic System Prompt

Without Performance Data (Phase 1-2):

"Generate an action for handmade leather seller, women 25-45 customers, 5 hrs/week, goal: 10 sales."

With Performance Data (Phase 3):

"Generate an action for handmade leather seller, women 25-45 customers, 5 hrs/week, goal: 10 sales. This merchant has completed 45 actions. Performance: Instagram 14% engagement, 2% conversion. TikTok 6% engagement, 1% conversion. Email 4% click-through, 3% conversion. Prioritize Instagram and email. Deprioritize TikTok."

4.2 Implementation

When generating daily action:

- Query StrategyPerformance for merchant
- Identify top 3 performing platforms by conversion rate
- Identify any underperforming platforms to avoid
- Build performance summary string
- Include in Claude system prompt
- Generate action with performance-informed context

5. Merchant Visibility

Add a Performance Dashboard section showing merchants their own data:

- Platform Performance: Instagram 14%, TikTok 6%, Email 4% CTR
- Action Type Performance: Video posts outperform carousels
- Top 5 Best Performing Actions with metrics
- Conversion Funnel: Reach to Engagement to Sales
- 30-Day Trend: Is performance improving?

Transparency builds trust. When merchants see their data reflected in recommendations, they understand why the AI suggests what it does.

6. Cross-Merchant Patterns

After 50+ merchants with data, aggregate learnings by niche:

- Fashion sellers: Instagram and TikTok outperform email
- B2B sellers: Email and LinkedIn outperform social
- Handmade sellers: Pinterest and Instagram both strong
- Price tier impacts channel effectiveness

This becomes Phase 4 work: niche-specific system prompts informed by aggregate merchant data. But Phase 3 collects the data that makes it possible.

7. Timeline

Phase 3 takes approximately 3-4 weeks of development:

- Week 1: Database schema, ActionResult and StrategyPerformance tables
- Week 2: Nightly aggregation job, metric calculations
- Week 3: Update action generation to query and use performance data
- Week 4: Performance dashboard UI, testing

START PHASE 3 WHEN: You have 50+ active merchants, Phase 2 is stable, and merchants are actively logging results. Not before.